METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Biodiversity & Land Use Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Biodiversity & Land Use Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Biodiversity & Land Use is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. MSCI S&C evaluates companies on the potential impact of their operations on biodiversity in their areas of operation and their efforts to manage the environmental impact of their operations.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	**Biodiversity & Land Use**
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Loss of formal and social license to operate.
- Litigation by landowners and other affected parties.
- Increased costs of land protection and reclamation.

Biodiversity & Land Use Key Issue score

The Biodiversity & Land Use Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Biodiversity & Land Use Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Biodiversity & Land Use Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

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Component	Sustainability Indicator
Biodiversity & Land Use Policy & Disclosure score	Involvement with external stakeholder groups to address the biodiversity impacts of its operations
	Scope of third-party engagement or standard to address the biodiversity impacts of operations
	Commitment to minimize disturbances on biodiversity
	Commitment to reclaim habitat on disturbed land
	Scope of biodiversity and land reclamation policy
Biodiversity & Land Use Programs & Structures score	Extent of programs to protect ecosystems
	Conducts biodiversity impact assessments
Biodiversity & Land Use Performance score	Oil spills performance relative to peers.

Biodiversity & Land Use Management score

The Biodiversity & Land Use Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by Controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice and 0 corresponding to lack of management. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

MSCI S&C uses the following formula to calculate the Biodiversity & Land Use Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.

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- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Biodiversity & Land Use Policy & Disclosure score

The Biodiversity & Land Use Policy & Disclosure score evaluates the company's disclosure of biodiversity and land use policies, including commitments to habitat restoration, minimizing disturbances, engagement with external stakeholders or standard to address the biodiversity impacts of operations. it is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Involvement with external stakeholder groups to address the biodiversity impacts of its operations**

Definition: Indicates whether there are external stakeholder groups that work with the company to address the biodiversity impacts of its operations.

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- **Scope of third-party engagement or standard to address the biodiversity impacts of operations**

Definition: The estimated share of operations with ecosystem protection programs certified or assured by an external stakeholder group.

- **Commitment to minimize disturbances on biodiversity**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has disclosed an explicit commitment to minimize disturbances on biodiversity, for example following the mitigation hierarchy of "avoid, minimize, restore and offset."

- **Commitment to reclaim habitat on disturbed land**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has disclosed an explicit policy to eventually reclaim the habitat of all disturbed land.

- **Scope of biodiversity and land reclamation policy**

Definition: The scope of operations covered by the company's disclosed biodiversity and land reclamation policy, where applicable (i.e., all operations including its supply chain, all direct operations, or partial operations).

Biodiversity & Land Use Programs & Structures score

The Biodiversity & Land Programs & Structures score evaluates the company's ability to manage biodiversity impacts through structured programs and practices, including ecosystem protection initiatives and biodiversity impact assessments for new operations. it is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Extent of programs to protect ecosystems**

Definition: Assesses the comprehensiveness of the company's steps to protect ecosystems, for example, whether the company creates ecosystem reserves vs. isolated initiatives to protect single species, and whether such practices apply to all major sites or only selected operations.

- **Conducts biodiversity impact assessments**

Definition: Indicates whether the company conducts biodiversity impact assessments prior to settling in new areas.

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Biodiversity & Land Use Performance score

The Biodiversity & Land Use Performance score evaluates the company's performance on biodiversity & land use metrics (oil spill intensity) relative to its peers. It is expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong performance.

- **Oil spills performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on oil spills intensity (normalized by sales), and trend in oil spills intensity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Oil spill intensity industry relative score**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on oil spill intensity metrics (total volume of oil spilled normalized by sales) relative to its industry peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

  - **Three-year average oil spill intensity (sales based)**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year average oil spill intensity, calculated as total oil spill volume per unit of sales.

- **Oil spill intensity industry relative trend score**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year trend in oil spill intensity (year-over-year change in oil spill volume normalized by sales) relative to its industry peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

  - **Three-year average year-over-year oil spill intensity trend (sales based)**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year trend in oil spill intensity.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The result is the Management score. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Biodiversity & land use controversies.
- Oil spills.
- Toxic releases to water/land controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to Section: Controversies cases, of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

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Biodiversity & Land Use Exposure score

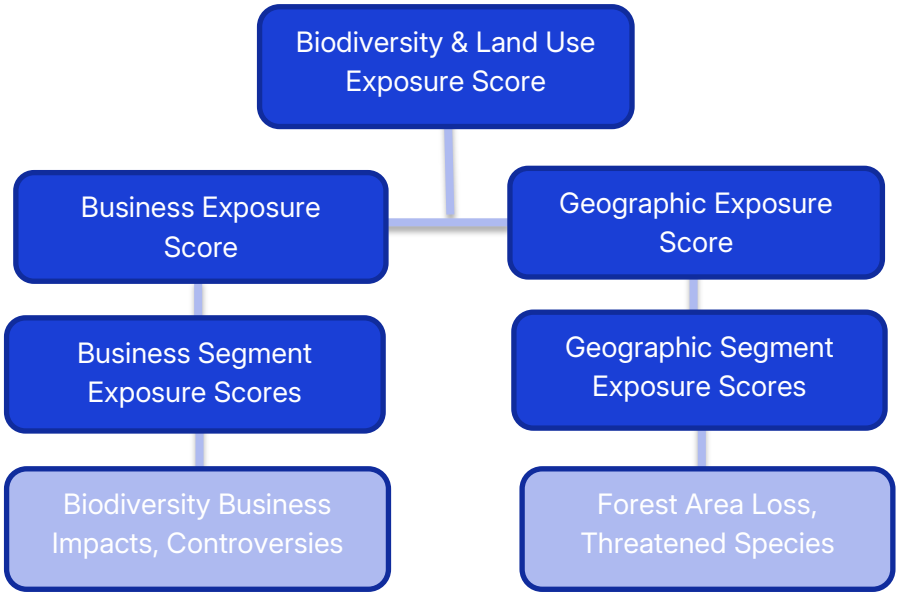
The Biodiversity & Land Use Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Geographic Exposure scores. The Geographic Exposure score functions as a multiplier on the Business Exposure score, with an impact ranging from -50% to +50%. The Business and Geographic Exposure scores are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to Section: Analyzing risk exposure, of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

$$EXP_{BIO,i} = BUS_{BIO,i}(1 + 0.1(GEO_{BIO,i} - 5))$$

Where:

- $EXP_{BIO,i}$ is the Biodiversity & Land Use Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{BIO,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $GEO_{BIO,i}$ is the Geographic Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



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Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. MSCI S&C weights scores by the proportion of a company's total assets in each business segment,[2] using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{BIO,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Asset,i,j} BSE_{BIO,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{BIO,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Asset,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company assets.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure scores

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by a simple average of the Biodiversity Business Impacts score and the Controversies score of the business activity.

$$BSE_{BIO,j} = \frac{BBIS_j + CS_j}{2}$$

Where:

- $BBIS_j$ is the Biodiversity Business Impacts score for business activity j.
- CS_j is the Controversies score for business activity j.

The Biodiversity Business Impacts score of a business activity is assessed by examining the business impacts that are present for that activity. Nine business impacts arising from biodiversity and ecosystem changes are considered such as disruption of operations, restricted access to land and resources and litigation. For each business activity, each impact is presented as a 0 or 1 value, with 1 indicating that the impact is present. The number of impacts that apply to each activity is counted and scaled to a factor of 10 to calculate the Biodiversity Business Impacts score.

[2] The percentage of assets is typically calculated as the company-reported asset value of the segment divided by the total asset value. In certain cases, industry-specific metrics are used to calculate the percentage of assets, such as power generation, production volume or reserve value. In cases where neither segment assets nor a relevant industry-specific proxy is available, the percentage is calculated based on segment revenue.

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The Controversies score of a business activity is determined by the percentage of companies involved in a biodiversity controversy assessed as Moderate to Very Severe among all the companies with the same primary business activity.[3] Refer to Section: Controversies cases, of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for details on how the severity of controversy cases is assessed.

Geographic Exposure score

The Geographic Exposure score is a weighted average of the Geographic Segment Exposure scores of the countries, markets and regions in which a company operates. MSCI S&C weighs scores by the proportion of a company's total assets in each geographic segment through the following equation:

$$GEO_{BIO,i} = \sum_{r=1}^{n_i} w_{Asset,i,r} GSE_{BIO,r}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{BIO,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of region r.
- $w_{Asset,i,r}$ is the weight of total assets in region r for company i based on the contribution to total company assets.
- n_i is the number of geographic segments for company i.

For geographic segments disclosed as regions (example: Asia Pacific), a nominal GDP-weighted country or market aggregation is used to calculate region-level scores, using the following equation:

$$GSE_{BIO,r} = \sum_{c=1}^{n_r} w_{GDP,r,c} GSE_{BIO,c}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{BIO,c}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of country or market c.
- $w_{GDP,r,c}$ is the specific weight of country or market c within region r.

[3] The primary business activity of a company is the industry, as defined by the SIC System, that is the largest contributor to its total assets.

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Geographic Segment Exposure scores

The Geographic Segment Exposure score is determined by a simple average of (1) average annual forest area loss score, and (2) the number of threatened species score in the country or market:

$$GSE_{BIO,c} = \frac{AFL_c + NTS_c}{2}$$

Where:

- AFL_c is the average annual forest area loss score in country or market c. It is calculated from the 5-year average annual forest area loss (1,000 Ha) per country or market.
- NTS_c is the number of threatened species score in country or market c.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Biodiversity & Land Use Exposure score:

World Resources Institute, "Global Forest Watch;" World Resources Institute; UNDP Human Development Reports; Refinitiv; MSCI S&C; company disclosures.

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